February 94

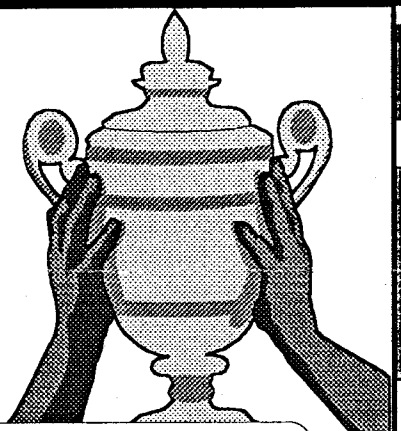
MOUNTAINSIDE

NEAR THE FINISH LINE

Agreement Imminent

An agreement between CMA and CDC was not yet completed as of February 15. The weather can't be blamed, although getting around in the winter mess of 1994 hasn't helped your negotiators, advisors and committee members who have helped to formulate

the content. The arbitration proceedings initiated against CDC by the association were stayed in an effort to reach an in-depth business agreement with the development company. The document is nearly complete. April 9, 1994 has been set for a membership ratification meeting. The new agreement, once approved by your Board of Directors, will be mailed to every member.



Upgrades Still A Dream

A WALK IN THEIR SHOES

For Association history aficionados, you may gain some pleasure in knowing that the document preparation, negotiation and communications involved in achieving our new working agreement with CDC are fully reminiscent of 1986 trials and tribulations. To reach 100% agreement with Coolfont management on issues like expansion, water, sewer, road development standards, monetary arrangements and all the inherent legal protections both parties expect, extraordinary attention to detail is required. CMA has high standards for the development of the mountain-side. And yes, like '86, we have among our membership ranks vocal experts on nearly every topic; law, banking, water quality, roads, wetland construction, surveying, risk assessment, maintenance, forest conservation and document writing. The 1986 agreement was crafted by a committee. '94 is following suit!

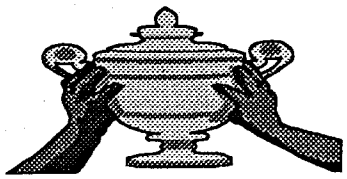
ICE

You Be Careful Now

The hot topic remains settlement with CDC, but this lead column is devoted to ice. Some of us who are approaching the back nine can't afford to break anything, our hips, our cars or our waterpipes. This winter is one of the worst in memory. Thousands of

extra dollars have been spent by the association for snow removal and sometimes to little avail. The best cars are no good on ice and the best people, even with an uncanny knack for getting around on the stuff, are having their problems. We've spread gravel, cleared driveways as contracted and shut off water when we detected broken pipes in homes. Our resources are thin and the problems many. The sun will come out -- tomorrow.

Agreement Content Discussion - Next Board of Directors Meeting You're Invited



Board Meeting-10:00 AM March 5, 1994 Davis Library 6400 Democracy Blvd. Bethesda, Md.

WATER QUALITY

Board Takes Action

Reflecting the will of the membership, the CMA Board of Directors at its February meeting voted to carefully analyze water quality in wells, reservoirs and outlets in an effort to assure the finest water quality possible. CMA voluntarily complies with the highest state standards for water testing. However, as upgrades to the water system are planned, safety and quality of the water supply is to be examined. One CMA member, Jim Groff, an expert on community water systems has provided the CMA Long-Range Planning Committee with plenty of food for thought on the subject and an action plan will be formulated to conduct all testing, analysis and reporting before construction on a new reservoir and system upgrades are begun.

NAMES IN THE NEWS

Mr. and Mrs. Albert McCoubrey have purchased G-5 and we welcome them to the Coolfont Community.

Carl Bostrom has taken on responsibility for refining CMA By-Laws. Member ideas that have been placed in writing over the last six months are being reviewed.

George Piper of the West Virginia law firm of Martin and Seibert is the CMA attorney for the new agreement.

Alice Minnamon is CMA's person on the scene to accomplish driveway snow removal. Give Alice ample notice to order work. Her # is 304-258-5352

THE COST OF FREEZE UPS

A broken water pipe in a Coolfont home is no small matter. Recommended in this newsletter was the practice of leaving enough heat in each home during the winter to avoid pipe freeze-up. A broken pipe left unattended can cost a homeowner big dollars in water bills and damaged property. The practice of leaving faucets open for trickling water was strongly discouraged. An entire water supply in a reservoir can been dramatically affected by broken pipes in homes. With absentee homeowners, locating a home pipe break problem can be time consuming and expensive for the association. One homeowner left a window open and the freezing cold broke a pipe. Another turned off the heat and left water trickle.

CLEAN CHIMNEY FLUES

A build-up of creosote and other chemicals in stove pipes can cause fires. Every homeowner should have flue pipes inspected and cleaned on occasion. Kerosene heaters can be dangerous if proper ventilation is not provided. Homes with closed windows don't exchange air readily, especially in the winter. Electric space heaters should not be left unattended. The Berkeley Springs Volunteer Fire Company wants homes clearly identified in the event emergency equipment must be dispatched. They also want 12' wide unobstructed lanes to reach each home.